Important Points to Remember while Drafting Patterns

- Patterns should be made larger than the body size by adding ease allowance to the actual measurement. This gives the garment freedom of movement, ease, and comfort in wearing. Normally 5 cm allowance is given around the chest and 1 to 2.5 cm for other measurements.
- For identical designs where the right and left side of the garment is same, only one side is needed to be made in paper. It can be reserved and copied for the opposite side.
- It is better to draft the basic pattern block first then while cutting, seam allowances should be added to the pattern and markings should be made on the fabric.

The following construction detailed information should be recorded and marked clearly (Figure 10.7).

a) Name of each piece of pattern.

b) Number of pieces to be cut with each pattern piece.

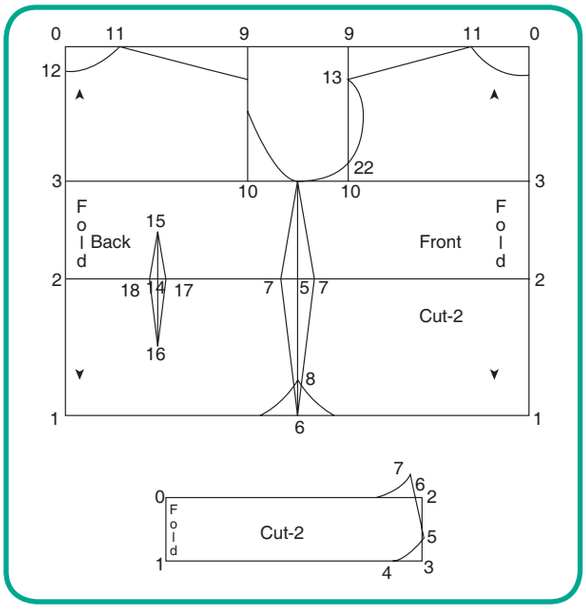


Figure 10.7 **Drafted Pattern**

c) If seam allowance is included in the draft, seam lines and cutting lines should be clearly shown using blue and red pencil respectively.

d) Straight grain or lengthwise line should be drawn on all patterns with a red pencil as shown (← — →). This line indicates the direction in which the pattern has to be kept on the cloth so that it is parallel to the selvedge.

e) Matching notches or balance marks should be provided along seams to show which seams are to be joined together.

f) It is advantageous to cut outward notches at centre front and centre back of pattern pieces as it helps at the time of assembling the garment and stitching collars.

g) Folding lines, dart marking, pleat markings etc. should be clearly shown.

h) Draping technique can be mastered by carefully following the instruction and drawing the patterns in a systematic manner.

10.3.2 Draping

Toils and modeling are another common terms used to describe draping. Draping is the manipulation of fabric on a three dimensional form by a designer to obtain perfect fit and harmony between the fabrics and design of the garment and the silhouette of the individual. The material is modeled around a dress stand or human body to see the fit. It is checked, marked and then cut and finally stitched. There are several types of dress forms available

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